

Community Benefits Agreement (CBA)

What this tool produces · *A legally binding contract between a private developer and a coalition of community organizations guaranteeing specific local benefits (e.g., affordable housing, living-wage jobs).*

G4 · Proof of Sustainability

G3 · Proof of Anchoring

Dimensions

Economic

Social / User

Regulation

Preparing the workshop · *Community Benefits Agreement (CBA)*

G4 · Proof of Sustainability

Why this tool matters

Transforming the violence of gentrification and displacement into a legally binding pact of mutual prosperity, demanding that those who profit from the city also nourish its roots.

Evidence we produce

A legally binding contract between a private developer and a coalition of community organizations guaranteeing specific local benefits (e.g., affordable housing, living-wage jobs).

Duration & Material

Duration · 6 to 18 months for organizing and negotiation

Material · Legal contract templates, community organizing resources, socio-economic baseline data

Reference case

Analyzed heavily in the political economy of urban development, CBAs are utilized by community coalitions to hold massive development projects accountable. By requiring developers to sign enforceable contracts prior to securing municipal zoning variances, residents have successfully mandated the inclusion of living-wage jobs and environmental mitigations, ensuring that megaprojects tangibly benefit the existing neighborhoods rather than displacing them.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Community contract · commitments · enforcement

Duration
6 to 18 months for organizing and negotiation

Coalition who signs on the community side	Developer commitments jobs · housing · amenities	Monitoring joint committee · KPIs	remedies when breached
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Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.